(iii) **Modular Units:** Modular units are becoming increasingly popular now. These units normally consist of a combined desk and filing cabinet with dwarfed partitions up to a height of four to six feet. The most popular type of modular desk is the L pattern desk unit with a flat surface.

3.5. Office Environment:

Office environment has an important bearing on the efficiency of employees. It is common experience that people work better if they are given the surroundings and equipment appropriate to their work. According to **Terry**, "an individual's performance is significantly familiarized by the environment in which he works".

3.5.1. Lighting:

Lighting is the most important of all the physical conditions in the office. Proper lighting is important because it offers the following advantages:

- Increased productivity
- Better quality of work
- It results in fewer errors
- Reduction in eye strain and mental fatigue
- Better employee morale

Factors in Good Lighting:

Basic factors in good lighting are:

(i) **Quantity of Light:** It is necessary that the correct quantity of light is available for different types of work in the office.

(ii) **Brightness of Light:** The light should provide the right degree of intensity and brightness. It can be described as the amount of light reflected from an object. It also controls contrast which affects seeing.

(iii) **Diffusion of Light:** Proper diffusion of light can be obtained by having light in different amount that come from an adequate number of sources and directions and should not throw any shadow. It should also be spread uniformly over all parts of the working place.

Sources or Kinds of Lighting:

There are two main kinds of light available:

(i) **Natural Lighting:** The sun is the source of natural lighting which is considered as the best form of lighting from the point of view of the health and efficiency of the employees. Day light is admitted through large windows in the walls or from the roof.

(ii) **Artificial Lighting:** Artificial lighting may be used to supplement natural light. It is generally not possible to provide natural light over the whole working surface; artificial lighting has to be provided so that the working surface may be properly and evenly illuminated. Artificial lighting is of two kinds

a) **Fluorescent:** The illumination produced by fluorescent lighting closely resembles that of natural lighting. The light is evenly distributed and produces

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